Catra's Past (Rewrite)

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/39320709.

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Mature

Archive Warning:
Graphic Depictions Of Violence

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She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

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Adora/Catra (She-Ra)

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Adora (She-Ra), Catra (She-Ra), Original Characters, Luna (Catra's Mother), Dawn (Catra's Mother), Razz (She-Ra), Huntara (She-Ra)

Additional Tags:
Finding Halfmoon Series, Catra's Past, First Meetings, prequel story, Finding Halfmoon Prequel Story, catradora, Kid Fic, Past Adora/Catra (She-Ra), Catradora growing up, Life in the Horde (She-Ra), Fluff and Angst, War, Battlefields, Not Overally Graphic but Warning Nessecary, Rewrite, Catra has two moms

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Part 4 of Finding Halfmoon Series - Prequel Stories and Extra Content Chapters

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by Midnight_Owl2

Summary

We all know that Catra was found in a box by Adora in the Fright Zone when they were little. But how exactly did Catra end up in the Fright Zone to begin with? How did her story begin? Where did she come from? What events happened that lead to her growing up in the Fright Zone as a Horde Soldier?

Notes

This fic is an extra chapter to my original fic: Finding Halfmoon. Although not necessary for this prequel chapter, I highly advise reading Finding Halfmoon at least up to chapter 7 (Answers) first if you want to follow the story and avoid potential spoilers for that fic.

Finding Halfmoon Readers - This chapter is a prequel story that comes way before the She-Ra series even begins. It's simply my interpretation on how I believe Catra ended up in the Horde. It is a rewrite version as I initially created another version of Catra's Past for TATEOTW. This one was created to match the Finding Halfmoon story but also has more detail about her parents in it. Hope you enjoy. 😊

P.S If you want to read more about Catra's and Adora's adventures growing up, why not give the You & Me series a read (link here: https://archiveofourown.org/works/32983975/chapters/81864034). Some parts may appear as memories/discussions in Finding Halfmoon.

See the end of the work for more notes

It's a cool autumn afternoon in the Whispering Woods. Magic flows through like it always has, but Madam Razz remembers a time when the magic was stronger and the world was at peace, *or so it seemed*. The First-Ones destroyed most of that memory and took with them one of the bravest warriors even known. Now all that remains is a devastating war between those who believe they are pure and those who rebel. A new champion awaits but there is still a while to wait before they arise.

Razz is waiting outside her hut, waiting for something that she wasn't quite aware of just yet. Her mind is foggy but she can sense that something pure evil is to happen today, but what?

A small tugging at the end of Razz's robes brings her back to the reality. She looks down to find a small bundle of fluff, with sharp claws, a swaying tail, huge cat-like ears and heterochromic eyes staring at her robes ready to pounce on them once more.

The small Magicat is Catra, or at least that's who Razz knew her to be. Catra is a name that Razz is aware will be given to her very soon, by someone who she will hold dear to her heart forever. The person who will give this Magicat her name is someone Razz will help guide on her new journey within the next decade or so, just like she did many, *many* years before with her dear Mara. How these two will meet Razz does not know, but something tells her it will be something to do with the events that keep fading from her mind.

"Catra dearie, what are you doing?" Razz asks as she looks down at the small kitten who stares back and giggles at her in response. She holds a loose rag of Razz's gown tightly in little claws, proud of capturing her 'prey'.

Razz bends down and gently picks up the small Magicat, scratching her behind her ears. The small kitten responds by emitting the loudest purr Razz has ever heard.

“Pie?” The young Magicat eventually responds. The young kitten is very skilled when it comes to communicating. She is a fast learner and has picked up on some of the most complicated words that her species say. Pie however was taught by Razz.

“Oh dearie we have to wait for Mara. I bet she can’t wait to see how big you’ve grown.”

The young magicat in her arms looks at Razz confused. They have only ever heard of this person called Mara but have never seen her. Seeing the kittens confused look and cute twitching ears, Razz caves…

“Well I suppose a slice of pie why we wait for your mother to get back wouldn’t hurt. I’m sure my Mara won’t mind. After all she was a bit of a rule breaker when growing up.”

The young Magicat giggles in Razz’s arms and wriggles out of her grip, walking on all fours into the hut. Razz smiles to herself. Razz has been alone for many years, to many years that she can’t seem to recall. Time passes differently for Razz, it can be… *well… confusing.*

Madam Razz moves to follow the young Magicat inside, but she has to steady herself with her trusty broom as another vision floods her mind. Madame Razz knows all too well that what she is seeing may have happened before but something about this feels different.

Razz’s vision is interrupted when she feels a familiar tugging on her robes. She looks down to find a concerned young kitten looking back at her.

“Is Razz okay?”

Razz looks down to her tiny friend, a weak smile appearing across her face. Who would have thought that this little ball of fur would have stumbled into her hut about a year ago and become Razz’s friend. Unfortunately, Razz is worried that if her vision is as it

seems, this may be the last time she sees the small kitten for many years.

Not wanting to worry the young Magicat, Razz responds with her a phrase she knows will lighten the mood.

“What dear? You’ll have to speak up. I can’t hear you without my glasses.”

That earns a giggle from the young kitten. Over the past year, despite the kittens young age, she has come to learn that Razz can sometimes be confusing, or at least that’s what her mother says. Nevertheless, the young kitten likes Razz just the way she is.

Both head inside and have some pie: blueberry to be exact. The small kitten is a messy eater, blueberry going all over her face but it shows Razz that’s she clearly enjoys it. She attempts to lick the blueberry around her mouth off her face. Magicats have incredibly long tongues. They always win the 'touch your nose with your tongue' games. After a few moments and full clean face later, the young kitten asks Razz about Mara…

“Tell me about Mara.”

The kitten beams up at Razz with wide eyes and a playful grin on her face…

“Pwease.”

The young kitten is still learning how to pronounce certain words, ‘please’ being one of them. Razz can’t deny the child’s request and her cuteness makes her even more adorable.

“Alright dearie. I will tell you. My Mara was a warrior, a protector, a hero. She was known as ‘She-Ra – the Princess of Power’.

The young kitten watches Razz with amazement, carefully listening to her every word. The story of She-Ra fascinates her but also scares her. The princess of power was said to be a protector but mysteriously disappear from Etheria many years ago. The

tales of her sheer size and power are enough to make the young Magicats fur stand on end. However, deep down, she also imagines this She-Ra as someone beautiful, not that she's sure what that word means, but she's heard her mama call her mom beautiful many times so she assumes it must mean something good.

"She-Ra was the protector of Etheria, powerful, caring and courageous. Unfortunately the First-Ones wanted to control that power, to use She-Ra as their weapon. My Mara saw through their little act and rebelled against them. She realized that all she was taught was a lie. She was the chosen one, but not for the destiny that she was originally forged. She was the chosen one for a destiny that saved everyone. She was brave my Mara."

Razz goes quite after a few moments and the young kitten realizes that's the end of the story. She wants to ask what happen but she knows better than to not to.

The drape of the hut moves open letting in a beam of light, but a slender figure blocks part of the sun from entering. The figure that stands before them takes a few steps forward. She has a long tail and ears just like the young kittens but there are a few differences. Her fur is a silverish grey, her hair is a dark shade of bronze, her forearm stripes are a mix of darker colours and she has piercing blue eyes. She is wearing a purple robe that covers her chest and lower waist, black leather leggings that come up to her knees and wrap around the pads of her feet. Most recognizable of all is the crimson red mask that rests of her head.

"Afternoon Razz. How was your day, and how's my little kitten doing?"

"Mommy."

The young kitten leaps from her seat on one of the huts stools and leaps into her mother's arms. The kittens mother, Luna, immediately scenting her kitten cheeks, a comforting and lovable action in Magicats as she begins purring.

“How was your day with Madam Razz? I hope, you haven’t been causing too much chaos.” Luna jokes as her kitten settles in her mother's hold.

“I’ve had a good day. We made pie, Razz told me stories, and I made my first kill.”

The young kitten points to Razz’s robes where her claw marks are visible. Razz doesn’t seem to mind. Luna hums in approval, watching her kittens claws kneed into the fur surrounding her collar bone. Her kitten did this from the moment she first held her. It’s a special memory for her and her wife, especially after everything they went through to have their little miracle.

“Thanks for watching her today Razz. Dawn and I really appreciate it. This little one has been quite the handful recently, but we wouldn’t change it for the world, especially if it means we can keep our kingdom and our kitten safe.”

“Not a problem dearie. Me and Catra have had the best time haven’t we.”

The young kitten giggles and Luna rolls her eyes. She’s lost count of how many times she has told Razz that that’s not her kittens name but she knows Razz can sometimes get confused.

“What do you say to Madame Razz for taking care of you?”

“Thank you Razz.”

As Luna turns to leave, Razz’s mind is once again *gifted* with visions of what has yet to happen. That's when she see a figure in her mind, running from the flames, trying to escape a new evil. Razz has to warn them…

“Oh Luna dear.”

“Yes Razz.”

Madame Razz goes to speak but immediately forgets what to say. *Why does this always happen to Razz? Think Razz think.* When nothing reboots Razz's mind she thinks of something else to say.

"Hope you have a safe journey home."

"We will Razz. We'll see you soon. Have a nice night."

Little did they know, soon would be a very long time away.

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On their journey back home, Luna's mind can't help but wander back to the conversations that had occurred earlier that day. Decisions had to be made. Tactics had to be strategized. Worries ran high…

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"The Horde keeps making ground day by day. It's only a matter of time before the infiltrate our boundaries."

"You don't think I'm aware of that General? I'm aware that the Horde is almost on our doorstep but I don't see you offering anything useful. I'm running out of options here. I was left with a kingdom to protect, a kingdom that I darest might say that I never wanted to lead in the first place, especially not after the way everyone saw me simply because of the woman I loved. But I took oath to protect this kingdom, a kingdom that I promised to protect in spite of all that has happened. It just seems at the moment no matter what I do is good enough, and you are one of those people who are making that clear. We only have a few options left and I fear what you are suggesting may put us in

more danger. The option I'm proposing is the only one that we have left if we want to get out alive.

The general goes to protest when a Shadow appears by the queens side…

"I know you might not agree with this proposal general but my wife is giving you the best of our remaining options. I know what you think of me, simply because of my background statues, but believe me when I tell you that my wife and I will do anything to protect our kingdom, and we will do anything possible to protect our miracle."

The general looks back to the queen with a hard scowl, before sighing…

"I suggest that we reinforce the boundaries first before we make this rash decision. I served your parents for many years and I don't believe that they'd want you to abandon a kingdom they left to you without putting up a fight. If anything goes drastically wrong, I will signal the troops to evacuate and I can only hope that I'm still standing to advise you."

The general exists and Luna lets out a sigh of exhaustion. Really they need a new general but no one is as experienced, at least not yet. The plans, the preparations, the worries, it's all getting to her. She can't remember when she last got a decent nights rest. From behind, a set of soft hand massage her shoulders and she feels her wife place a gentle kiss to the top of her head.

"I never liked that bastard. I think it's about time he got an attitude adjustment don't you think?"

Luna giggles softly as she looks up to her wife. Dawn smiles down at her, giving her a soft smile…

"You did well today. I'm proud of you."

Luna starts to purr as she leans into her wife's soothing touch…

"Thank you… and thanks for having my back out there. I don't know what I'd do without you."

"Probably knocked his lights out if I didn't step in to hold you back and really I should have let you. You sure you don't want me to go and get our kitten."

"No it's okay. I know you've got a combat training session that you ideally want to get to. Not to mention we need someone to keep the peace will I'm gone. Beside, cuddles from our kitten will make me feel better."

With that Luna stands and kisses her wife. She promises to stay safe and return soon. The journey to Razz's isn't far, she just hopes the Horde hasn't made any advancements in the meantime.

Luna holds her kitten close to her chest, trying to hide any sense of worry that she might give off. She is brought back to her senses when she hears her kittens voice.

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"Mommy?"

"Yes my Kitten."

"Razz seemed to be forgetting stuff today. Is she okay?"

Luna has noticed this more and more frequently with Razz. She understands that Razz is… *well… ancient*. No one exactly knows how old she is, but some of Razz's stories, especially more recent ones, are becoming quite concerning.

Recently, the Horde has been taking ground in Halfmoon's territory. Unfortunately, the once proud Rebellion isn't as strong as it once was and many are now turning against each other in claims to protect their own. Queen Luna and Queen Dawn have been offered support from their allies in Brightmoon but they'd

rather not concern them, especially with their Queen and King expecting a child of their own very soon. They don't want to put them in danger or harm's way.

Luna and Dawn knew raising a child during the time of war would be difficult, but the news that they were expecting a kitten of their own after many years of trying was the light of hope they needed in this dark time.

Their kittens arrival was a scary time. She was born early and Magicat doctors feared for the new-born princess's life. However, Dawn knew that her daughter would pull though, she was strong, powerful and determined even despite only being a few hours old. Luna was reminded of that every time she felt that she had failed their daughter. Overtime it was clear for both mothers to see. Call it instinct but they could feel it, they could sense it. Their kitten was strong, she would survive.

The day Luna and Dawn were able to hold their kitten for the first time after her birth was the most magical day of their lives. They vowed to love and protect her for the rest of their lives. She meant everything to them, she was their miracle. They'd protect her with their lives, no matter the cost.

"Razz can sometimes get confused with the past and the present. Your mama believes that she can actually see into the future. However, Razz has been around for a very, *very* long time and sometimes can gets her stories muddled up."

"What about the story of She-Ra?"

"Now that one is a true story. In fact it's become legend. Unfortunately, the protector of Etheria hasn't been seen for many years. The last She-Ra was long before either me or you mama were born. We were told stories about her when we were kittens."

"That long ago?"

"Yes."

“Wow, you and mama are really old.”

Luna starts to laugh. Her daughter definitely has her wife’s sense of humour. Stars help her when she’s a teenager or even finds a soulmate of her own. Luna can’t begin to imagine that day but she knows all too well how quick they come and go.

“Wait till I tell your mama you said that.”

Both start to laugh as they enter the room that belongs to Luna and Dawn. There, standing on the balcony ledge sits another figure. She has broad shoulders and a kink in the tip of her tail, which is possibly the result of an old injury. Dawn was always knows for getting into trouble in her younger days. Her fur is a lighter shade compared to the young Magicats but has the same colour tone. Her mane and forearm stripes are a messy blonde colour. She’s wearing grey pants that cover her whole legs and a robes similar in style as Luna’s but is a forest green colour instead. As she turns to face her visitors, it’s clear to see that she has a pair of amber eyes and a happy smile appearing across her face.

“What do I owe the pleasure of meeting two beautiful Magicats?”

“Mama!”

The young Magicat practically squeals in her mother’s arms and begins to wriggle until she is passed over to her mama. Dawn cradles her daughter in a tight embrace, purring up a storm as she sways her side to side. Her kitten is her pride and joy. The day Luna told her that after may attempts that they were finally going to become parents, she practically leaped with joy. Some of the guards thought she had gone mad as they had never seen their queen this excited about anything. Both Dawn and Luna had awaited the day they would become parents; their daughter is her greatest treasure.

“How’s my little cute furball doing?” Dawn asks and her kitten giggles in response.

Dawn knows all too well that her daughter hates being called *princess*. The first time she called her kitten princess she hissed at her. Dawn can't stop smiling at the memory. *'Like mother, like daughter'* Luna told her and Dawn laughed. Besides, furball suits her far better.

"I'm not cute." The young kitten protests but her giggles lets down her defensive stance.

"You can't deny it sweetheart. Your half of me and half your mom and she is the most beautiful Magicat I have ever met… *besides you obviously but don't tell her I said that*."

"Well *your* daughter definitely has *your* sense of humour. That I am certain of. Do you know she called *us* old earlier?"

"Well she isn't wrong."

Luna looks gobsmacked that her wife, *her soulmate*, just agreed with their daughter. They're only in their mid-to-late twenties. It's worth it though to see their daughter in a fit of laughter. After the day they've had, their daughters' smile makes their day all the better.

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A few more hours pass. In that time young Magicat has had a fulfilling meal consisting of her favourite food, fish sticks, a nice warm bath, (*which she will admit she hates)* and is now sitting in the middle of her parents on their bed. Her mothers are quietly mumbling about something, but she's too tired to listen. In saying that she does pick up on a few words…

'Horde'… 'Evil'… 'Evacuation?'.

The young Magicat has never heard any of these words before and quite frankly is too tired to ask what they mean. Eventually the tired young kitten starts to yawn and her eyes start to fall heavy.

“Come on furball. I think it’s time for bed.”

The young Magicat simply lifts up her arms up asking to be carried. After a goodnight kiss from her mom, the young kitten is carried to her own bedroom by her mama. Dawn makes sure her daughters tail is wrapped underneath her blanket before tucking her in tightly. The young Magicat begins to purr, it’s a lot lighter sounding than her mama’s.

“Mama?”

“Yeah kiddo?”

“Can I ask you something?”

“Anything you want.”

“What does beautiful mean?”

At first Dawn is a bit taken back by what her daughter is asking? She wasn’t expecting that question, but she supposes she does say it around her wife and daughter a lot.

“Well my kitten, beautiful is a word I use to tell someone how I feel about them, that I love them. So, let me think how do I explain this… got it. I call your mother beautiful because I like the way she looks, not just on the outside but also on the inside. She’s smart, pretty and she makes me happy. When I am with her I feel happy, I feel loved and I feel like my world is complete. It's hard to describe what it means when beauty is found within your heart. Does that make sense?”

Dawn isn’t quite sure if she has answered her daughters question or has just confused her even more. Maybe this is something she should get Luna to answer.

“I think I get it…”

Dawn breathes a sigh of relief but then her kitten speaks again.

“But mama, you said loved. What does love mean?”

Now this question Dawn can answer easily.

“Love is a deep feeling that you feel for someone or something. There are many different forms of love but they all make you feel the same way. You feel all sort of feelings when your with them. The best feeling is being happy and feeling like you can't live without them. Falling in love can be scary at first, but love makes you strong and gives you the courage you need to take on the world. I love you and your mom more than anything in this world. I will do anything to protect you because of the love I have for you.”

“Do you think I’ll ever find someone to love like the way you love mommy.”

Dawn chuckles her daughters remark. She can’t imagine her little kitten growing up. She wants her to stay this small forever, but she also wants her to find her own path and fall in love with the person she is destined to spend the rest of her life with. The fear of her little kitten growing up is scary but getting watching her grow and learn is the most rewarding part of being a parent.

“You’re a bit too young to be worrying about that at the moment, but I know whoever you end up loving and loves you in return, will be the luckiest person alive.”

The young Magicat starts to purr and her eyes slowly start to close. Dawn brushes a small strand of hair out of her kittens eyes and places a gentle kiss to the top of her daughters head.

“Sleep well little one.”

After checking that her daughter is fast asleep, she makes her way back to her room where she left her wife.

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It’s a short walk from her daughters room to her and her wife’s room. They’re quite literally just across the corridor.

Dawn remembers when they first left their daughter to sleep in her own room once she outgrew her cot that she slept in by her mothers’ bedside when she was a kitten. Their kitten seemed to take it in her stride. The new adjustment for the two new mothers however was a different story. They spent the first night sleeping on floor in sleeping bags, worried that their kitten would wake up in the night, scared of being in a new environment. Some said it was an overreaction but both Dawn and Luna wanted to be close to their kitten to hold and comfort her if needed. Thankfully, their kitten slept well through the night and she quickly learned that if she did happen to have a nightmare that her mothers were just across the hall.

Dawn often awoke to Luna cradling their kitten in her arms after she had a nightmare. Both mothers assured their kitten that there was nothing to be afraid of and that they’d protect her no matter what. They’d all then fall asleep in the same bed, protected from the nights worries.

Dawn can’t help but smile at the memory. She loved moments like that, where she could cuddle her wife and daughter throughout the night. However, her smile soon faded, her worries flooding her mind. There was a new threat close to their doorstep, a living nightmare, one she feared that she may not be able to chase away like she did when other monsters appeared. Regardless, Dawn promised that she’d protect her wife and daughter no matter what, even if the price was to lay down her life for them.

Dawn slowly opens the bedroom door and notices that her wife is standing on the balcony, looking out towards the night sky that’s

cast over their kingdom. Dawn smiles at the sight, her wife is as radiant as the day she met her. Just like the night sky, she is breath-taking.

Dawn quietly closes the door behind her, trying not to alarm her wife. Luna simply responds with the twitching of her ear and the slow sway of her tail. Dawn slowly walks up to her wife and wraps her strong arms around Luna's waist, holding her in a warm embrace. Luna tail wraps around Dawn's thigh and she rests her head against her wife's shoulder. Both begin to purr.

There isn't much of a height difference between the two, but Dawn is slightly taller than Luna. It wasn't always that way though. There was a time when they were both young Magicats that Luna was taller than Dawn. It looked like it was going to stay that way, that was until Luna stopped growing at the age of thirteen and Dawn had a sudden growth spurt. Dawn loves to tease her wife about it, especially when Luna needs to reach something on the higher shelves.

Dawn places a gentle kiss to her wife's exposed shoulder…
"What's on your mind?"

Luna hums to herself and turn in her wife's hold. They now have both arms wrapped around each other's backs. Dawns rests her heads over her wife's, whilst Luna presses her ear to her wife's chest, listening to her strong heartbeat.

Luna swears that Dawn knows exactly how she's feeling without her even saying a word. She's just good at reading her like that. She knows the right things to say and she knows exactly what to do. They're practically soulmates.

"Do you remember the day we met? How you fell out of that tree, crushed me and then happened to get your tail stuck in that tree branch and broke the tip."

"Of course I remember. It's impossible to forget, not to mention that I have a kink in my tail as a souvenir from that day. It was

one of the best days of my life, even if I didn't quite know it yet. Also, I didn't fall. I just happened to be sitting on a branch that snapped. If we're calling it falling let's call it *'falling with style'".*

Luna chuckles in her wife's embrace and snuggles into her warmth…

"You still fell and got your tail stuck! Anyway, it was the first time that I was actually able to perform any sort of real magic, real *Magicat* magic. It's the first time I had successful healed anyone. I couldn't have done that if I hadn't felt something, like some sort of connection to you. I never believed in soulmates up until that moment. I don't know what it was but in that moment, I felt connected to you. I felt something I had never felt before. Does that sound strange to you?"

Luna looks into her wife's eyes, worried that she has just ruined the content moment with her random thoughts. However, she finds Dawn looking down at her with a bright smile…

"It doesn't sound strange at all. I know exactly what you mean. I felt it too. Call it magic, fate, or *whatever*, but I believe we were meant to meet each other at that moment in time. Maybe the Whispering Woods deliberately broke that branch just so I could meet you."

"Or maybe you were just a little bit too heavy for the branch to hold you."

"Piss off or I'll divorce you!

Dawn lightly shovels her wife as Luna giggles. She loves winding up her wife.

"As I was saying, maybe the Whispering Woods deliberately broke that branch, *which seems to be more realistic as we know what the woods' magic is like*, just so I could meet you. Regardless of how it happened, I'm forever grateful that it did happen."

Luna leans up, lightly kisses her wife before going back to resting her head against her chest. Dawn begins to draw circles on her wife's back. Luna lets out a saddened sigh before speaking…

"I know my parents didn't approve of you simply because you weren't from a *'royal'* background. That still upsets me to this day. I didn't care that you came from an inventor family. I loved your creations and I loved you. I never cared what they thought about us being together because I knew deep down in my heart that you and I were meant to be. Those stolen moments from being best friends: the sparring in the training grounds, the *'hunting'* games when we'd chase leaves and bugs around the Whispering Woods to the first time you kissed me. Those precious memories when we became more than friends: stolen kisses here and there, the long nights on the mountain top looking up at the night sky wondering what lies beyond Etheria, to those secret nights whispering about… **blush* whatever*. I hold them all close to my heart."

Dawn squeezes her arms around her wife tighter and her purring grows stronger. Those moments are very precious for them. Life hadn't been easy for them. Dawn was orphaned in her teen years and Luna was a princess who was forced to have this ideal stature about what was expected as the future heir. The hardships of royal life made them later declare that there would be no more royal leaders of such after their deaths. Their daughter would be free to live her life as she chose whether that be as an individual or protector of Halfmoon.

Despite all their struggles, they found each other and made it through the good and the bad together. Their love for each other was powerful, something that could never be broken or torn apart.

"I never imagined life could be more prefect. I had everything I even wanted, ever needed in my life. And then we were gifted with our kitten, our little miracle"

Indeed a miracle their daughter was. Luna and Dawn had wished for a long time to be parents but life seemed to have other plans for them. It took its toll on both of them, but they had each other for support. After a while, they had come to accept that maybe being parents was not for them, but then by some wordless miracle they discovered that they were finally going to be blessed with their own child. Life is full of surprises, Dawn always said, and this defiantly was as surprise, especially after trying for so long with no success.

It was a joyous day for them both, one they never imagined would happen. However, even during Luna's pregnancy there was worry. Their daughter was born early, a worrying time for both the new mothers and their new born daughter. They were unable to hold her for the first few weeks after her birth due to her fragility. Their daughters' eyes where still tightly sealed and her ears lay flat against her head. Her tail remained curled. The only touch the new mothers could provide their daughter was to hold her tiny hands through the incubator holes. They longed to hold her close when she whimpered in the night or showed signs of distress when doctors where assessing her.

It pained the new mothers to know that they could do nothing to help. The only thing that seemed to soothe their daughter was Luna's singing. Dawn had always loved her wife's singing voice and it was clear that her daughter did to. When Luna sang or hummed her Magicat tune, their kitten would instantly settle and turn to face her mother. It was comforting to both mothers to know that despite not being able to hold their daughter just yet, they could do something that brought her to ease and enabled them to bond with her.

Both mothers spent many nights sleeping by their daughters side, holding onto hope that she'd pull through. When the four week mark arrived, both mothers cried tears of happiness when they got to hold their kitten for the first time since her birth. Dawn insisted that Luna held her first as she was her birth mother. She went through so much effort bringing her into the world that she wanted her wife to hold their daughter first.

As their daughter was placed onto Luna's chest, their kitten started to purr up a storm and began to kneed into her mother's fur. Both new moms placed a gentle kiss to their kittens head, thankful that she had pulled through. When it was Dawns turn to hold their daughter, she was nervous as she was unsure of what to do. Luna helped to position their kitten into her wife's arms before resting her head on her wife shoulder. Dawn breathed a sigh of relief when their kitten relaxed in her arms. Their daughters small paw wrapped itself around her Luna's finger, her grip incredibly strong.

Unexpectedly, their kittens eyes started to open: one amber and one blue. It was a surprise to both mothers as neither had expected their daughter to take on the features of both of her parents. Both Luna and Dawn had hoped that their kitten would have their other mothers eyes. Their kitten must have decided to take the best of both worlds: she was half Luna and half Dawn. Their daughter was perfect.

Luna's fur slightly stands on end. Dawn immediately senses this and tightens her grip around her wife. She places a gentle kiss to the top of her head. She can sense that wife is getting to the point where she's going to say what's troubling her, although she feels that she can already sense it.

"I'm scared Dawn. I'm scared that the Horde is going to take our kitten away from us, that they're going to attack in the night when we least expect it and we won't be able to protect her. I'm worried that our lives might be over before they even fully begin. I love you and our daughter so much that I'm terrified that it's all going to be taken away from me in the blink of an eye and even though I will do everything in my power to stop it… *it won't be good enough."*

Faint tears start to fall from Luna's eyes. She tries to steady her breathing by taking in her wife's scent, focusing on the sensation of her fur and the quite promises that Dawn whispers in her ear. Dawn also has a few tears in her eyes, but she tries to hold them back. She too fears for her wife and daughters life. They're her

world, her everything. She promised to protect them both and that's exactly what she's going to do.

Dawn holds her wife close and takes in a deep sigh before speaking…

"The day I met you Luna was one of the best days of my life. I don't know how I ended up being so lucky to meet you, or to be blessed with our beautiful daughter in our lives, but I thank my lucky stars everyday that this is the life I get to live. You are my best friend, the love of my life, my soulmate. I made a promise to you and our kitten that I would protect you no matter what. I will do everything in my power to keep you both safe. I love you both so much. Never forget that!"

The wives stay in the current position for a few more moments, holding each other close as darkness falls across the kingdom. A few more silent promises are shared, along with a few passionate kisses, before both head to bed.

That night everyone was unaware of the dangers lurking behind the trees, creeping closer towards their next target.

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The young sleeping Magicat is startled awake by a thunderous roar outside. Her room is lit with shadows of an amber-red colour from the reflections outside her bedroom window. She wants to investigate but is too scared to move.

Her doors come crashing down, to which she notices her mother's running to her side. They make sure she is alright before reassuring her that everything will be okay. Luna takes her kitten in her arms just as quickly as they entered her room and immediately make their way to the secret underground tunnels of Halfmoon.

The young Magicat asks her mother's multiple times what's going on but isn't answered. Her parents attention is focused on the path ahead.

Fires burst to life all around. The ground beneath them has been stained with a deep red colour. Mysterious flags with an unrecognizable symbols fly high in the sky. Frightened by the sights, the young Magicat simply hides her face against her mother's chest, trying to block out the sounds of screams and firing machinery from her thoughts.

The sounds eventually quieten but the young Magicat can still see a red light shining through her mother's fur. She shuts her eyes even tighter. She's not entirely sure what's going on but it scares her enough for her fur to stand on end.

"Luna you need to get out of here. Take our daughter somewhere safe and don't look back."

"I won't leave you Dawn!"

"I'm afraid you don't have much choice. I'm not going to let them get to you or our daughter. I promised you that I'd always protect you both. Please, take her and stay safe. I'll find you when this is all over. We'll find each other. Don't ever lose sight of hope. I love you both so much."

Luna and Dawn have tears in the eyes but they both know this is what must be done if they are to protect their kitten. They share a tender moment, afraid it might be their last. Dawn places a gentle kiss to her daughter head. She then looks to her wife and daughter one last time. She forces a smile to appear on her face. Luna holds Dawn's hand tightly one last time before allowing it to slowly slip from her wife's hold. Luna turns and makes her way further into the Whispering Wood, carrying their timid kitten in her grasp.

Dawn turns to face their flames, ready to fight whatever is about to come through the other side of the tunnel. Weapons, Horde

Soldiers, machinery, she can take it. However, none of those greet her. None of that comes. Instead she is greeted but a shadow that she thought she would never be seen again…

"*Hello Dawn.* How nice to see you again."

Dawn's fur stands on end, the shrill of a certain someone's voice sends an electrifying shiver down her spine. Her claws extend and a low growl emits in her chest. The sight that she once recognised is gone but the evil scent remains the same...

"Light-Spinner? I thought… I thought you were dead?"

"Foolish creature. Did you honestly think a bit of dark magic could stop me? I have learned to better understand its power and now with the power of the Black Garnet… **evil laugh*…* I am unstoppable! With the Horde's help I will eliminate every last creature and Etherian that ever doubted me, starting with you and your kind."

"Not if I have anything to do with it!"

A powerful roar emits from Dawn as she charges into battle.

The fight rages. Both sides taking heavy damage and each attack from both side makes significant impact. Permanent reminders of their battle are left marked within the soil and stone. Neither opponent are left without scars. Unfortunately, when their battle is over, only the evil remains standing.

--

Luna had been running for what feels like hours, loosing energy and strength with every step, but she has to go on, she's determined to keep her kitten safe. Unfortunately, time is against her. The Horde is moving at an alarming pace and she is

succumbing to her injuries, injuries that put both her and her daughter’s life at risk.

There are a series of hidden stacks just outside of Halfmoon's territory. The risk of leaving her kitten there is a great one, especially if her kitten was to be discovered but what choice does she have? She can’t risk keeping her kitten with her, not with the serve injury on her leg slowing her down. She wouldn’t be able to fight to protect them both again if they were caught. She’s already had to fight her way out once.

Her daughter is strong, not matter what happens she will survive. They will find each other, no matter how long it takes. Luna promises herself that.

It isn't long before Luna arrives at the stacks of crates and boxes just outside of Halfmoon. At least for now they're out of sight and range of the Horde’s advancements. Luna takes the opportunity to catch her breath and check on her kitten.

Luna looks down at the trembling kitten in her arms, clearly scared from the ordeal. She doesn’t want to leave her Kitten here but it’s a difficult choice that she must make if either are to have the best chances of survival. Both her and her wife vowed to protect their kitten at all costs and that’s exactly what she’ll do.

Luna leans down and starts rubbing her cheeks over her kittens head, scenting her, calming her down with her soothing purr. It’s difficult to purr with everything going on but she’ll do whatever it takes if it helps to calm her kitten.

The young Magicat starts to relax and releases her strong grip on her mother clothes. Luna is worried about what will happen next but she knows that this is her only reasonable option. She lifts the young Magicat higher and places her into a foldable cardboard box. At least she’ll be warm in there.

The young kitten looks back at her mother confused. Before she can say anything, Luna passes her the mask that rests on her

head…

“I need you to look after this for me. Can you do that?”

The kitten nods and nuzzles into her mother’s touch as her palm strokes her cheek. Luna is on the verge of tears but she refuses to let them fall. She doesn’t want what might be her daughters’ last memories of her to be with tears running down her face.

“How about we play a game of hide and seek? You hide and I’ll seek. I need you to hide in here and stay very quiet okay. I’m going to go and tell mama that we’re doing this okay. Then when she goes and hides I’ll come and seek you both.”

The young Magicat makes a worried mewling noise. Luna hasn’t heard her daughter make that noise since she was very little. The Magicat kitten can sense her mother's distress but nods in agreement at what she is asking of her.

Luna moves forward and places a gentle kiss to her kittens forehead before resting their head together…

“I love you very much. Never forget that!”

Luna gently closes the lid of the box, the only thing visible is her kitten shining eyes. Luna finally allows her tears to fall.

“I’m sorry my kitten.”

The young Magicat watches as she mother disappears in the distance. She holds her mother’s mask close and waits for her to return.

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Many hours pass and the dawn soon rises. The young Magicat barely slept last night due to the noises she heard in the distance. She wanted to run but remembered what her mother said. So she waited… and waited… and waited.

"We need to get some of these crates cleared so we can make a path to clear the debris in Halfmoon. See if there is anything we can salvage. Place empty crates over there."

The young kitten starts to panic. She doesn't recognize the voices. Her instincts tell her that danger is near. Despite her young age she is ready to fight for her life.

A muscular, purple figure peers into the gap of the box she is in. The Magicat kitten hisses at the creature, a light warning that she isn't afraid to fight.

"Hey, hey it's okay." The creature says. Her voice is calm but the young Magicat doesn't risk it and punctures her claws through the front panel of the box.

"Feisty one aren't you. Listen try and stay quite. I'm not going to hurt you. I'm going to help you okay?"

The figure smiles at the young Magicat in the box and she eventually calms down. She knows her mother told her to stay put but right now she's not sure what to do. However, if the sights and sounds from last night are anything to go off, she fears the worst. She might be young but she's not stupid.

Suddenly the box starts to move, jolting the young kitten around inside. She sneaks a peek at what lies outside. Tree have fallen and mysterious figures in grey metal suits are walking around. The strange flags are visible up above, causing her to close her eyes in fear.

It's not long before the ground beneath her starts to move and the image of the place she once called home becomes no more than a desert land. The desert land eventually becomes a grey, red and smoggy area. The noise itself it deafening and causes to

the young Magicat to fold her ears against her head. Eventually, the box that she is hiding in is unloaded and placed into a dark corridor.

"Sorry but I'm going to have to leave you here. Try and not sneak off. If you see a scary woman with a red mask, then run. Sorry but I can't do much more. Hopefully, I'll see you around. If you can survive here you can survive anywhere. I think you'd make good soldier. "

The mysterious figure then walks away. The young Magicat is unsure of who this *'red masked'* person is but she has no doubt she'll find out one day.

Time doesn't pass quickly, but the young Magicat still can't tell the time so she has no idea how longs it's been. She has drifted in and out of sleep but the strange smells of this mysterious place make it difficult to settle.

She is rudely awoken from her semi-sleep state when she hears a series of heavy footsteps running past her, followed by series of dark giggles and a pleading voice…

"Give it back. Shadow Weaver will kill me if I don't finish it."

"If you want it you'll have to catch us first."

Lighter footsteps start to pick up in speed before a figure trips in front of the box and lands flat on their face…

"Ouch." The figure says as she sits up and rubs the ride of her reddened cheek.

The young kitten quietly giggles to herself, but it obviously wasn't quite enough and the figure has slowly turned to face the box. Although not clearly visible to whoever or whatever this thing is, her shining eye make the young Magicats presence obvious.

The figure tilts their head slightly in curiously and moves closer to the box, causing the young Magicat to hiss in response and move

further towards the back of the box.

“It’s okay. I’m not going to hurt you. I just want to say hi.”

The figures tone is calm, reassuring the kitten inside the box that she may really just want to say hi. The figure smiles back and moves to kneel up to access the top of the box.

“You can come out if you want. I promise I won’t hurt you. Wait, are you trapped in there?”

Suddenly, the top of the box starts to open. At first, the young Magicat is scared, afraid that this may be the creature that the previous figure warned her about as part of her vision was blocked in the box. But no, the young Magicat couldn’t be more wrong. The young kitten looks up curiously at something that appears non-threatening but…*friendly?*

The figure stands not much taller than the young Magicat herself, in fact they look as though they might be the same age. The figure has a missing tooth between her front teeth, bright blonde hair and piercing blue eyes. The young kitten in the box makes no attempts to harm whoever this is. She doesn’t appear to be a threat. Instead this young kitten looks up directly into her eyes and lets out a small mewling noise. This time it’s a Magicat greeting noise. The young girl smiles back at the young kitten in the box…

“Hi, I’m Adora. Do you want to be friends?”

End Notes

Hope you enjoyed reading this extra chapter for Finding Halfmoon. There are more extra content chapters to come so keep an eye out for them.

Personally, I really enjoyed writing this version of Catra's past. Maybe it's because I got to explore more of what Catra's parent's were like. - It's difficult to say to much without revealing spoilers for potential Finding Halfmoon readers. 😂

Hope you enjoy reading this fic. Please let me know what you thought in the comments. I love hearing your thoughts. There are plenty more extra chapters to come. The next will be released when chapter 8 is released but until then, please continue to enjoy reading Finding Halfmoon 😊

Please drop by the archive and comment to let the author know if you enjoyed their work!